

Common toad

Amphibians need moisture to survive, but some are tolerant of a range of different habitats. The common toad, one of more than 600 toad species across the world, is the most widespread in Europe. It lives equally well in forests, alpine meadows, and dry sand dunes.

KEY

 Common toad range

Leaping high

Common toads generally move slowly and prefer to walk, rather than jump. But if danger threatens, they can leap to safety.

Defensive posture

Toads have poison glands in their skin to deter predators, but when threatened will stretch their legs and arch their back to look bigger for extra defense.

On the move

Common toads hibernate in winter, in mud burrows or beneath piles of logs or leaves. When spring comes, they travel overland back to the same ponds in which they were spawned, in order to breed.



**EACH EGG STRING LAID
BY A FEMALE COMMON TOAD
CAN CONTAIN UP TO**

2,000 EGGS